

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Layered society, not a court-peasant binary

TOP -> emperor/princes/nobles | LOCAL POWER -> rajas/zamindars

MIDDLE -> merchants + clerks + professionals + master artisans + lower service

RURAL -> khud-kasht + raiyati/muzarian + pahi-kasht + labour/service groups

AXES -> rank + caste/jati + lineage + religion + gender + locality + slavery

MOBILITY -> service + commerce + migration + cultivation + patronage

VERDICT -> hierarchy and mobility coexist; Bernier's binary is inadequate.

MUST REMEMBER: Peasants, zamindars, artisans, merchants and nobles occupied unequal positions within an agrarian-commercial economy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Nobility: mansab, household and reproduction

FORM -> ranked service aristocracy; mansab/jagir/office/household

ORIGIN -> immigrant and India-born Iranis/Turanis + Indian groups

LATE AURANGZEB -> under 10% of 1000-zat+ nobles born outside India

HOUSEHOLD -> retainers, stables, mansions, patronage and commerce

REPRODUCTION -> kinship helps but rank remains imperial and transferable

TRAP -> neither foreign caste nor modern bureaucracy alone.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Zamindars across a spectrum

RANGE -> village claimant -> deshmukh/taluqdar -> armed raja
RIGHTS -> hereditary local claims/perquisites; not absolute modern property
POWER -> garhi + retainers + caste/clan links + revenue mediation
STATE -> discipline + negotiate + recruit + use for cultivation/collection
JAGIRDAR -> transferable imperial revenue assignee; category differs
VERDICT -> pillar and constraint of Mughal rural authority.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Cultivators and layered rights

KHUD-KASHT/RIYAYATI -> resident, stronger occupancy/customary position
RAIYATI/MUZARIAN -> ordinary cultivator/tenant category
PAHI-KASHT -> incoming/non-resident; concessions and weaker embeddedness
INPUT -> cattle + seed + labour + water + credit determine capacity
MOBILITY -> migration/flight can bargain or signal distress
RULE -> jama != hasil; crop diversity != universal prosperity.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Women, work and source silence

LABOUR -> sow/harvest/animals + spinning/processing + construction/service

ELITE -> estate + ship/trade + charity + architecture + household patronage

LAW/PRACTICE -> property and inheritance rights meet unequal access

PURDAH/MARRIAGE -> vary by class, caste, region and occupation

SLAVERY -> domestic/military/court/labour forms; manumission does not erase it

SOURCE -> elite chronicles under-record ordinary women and coerced labour.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Towns and the middle strata

TYPES -> capital + provincial centre + port + qasba + pilgrimage/manufacture town

ACTORS -> merchant/shopkeeper + banker/broker + clerk + professional + artisan

DEMAND -> court/army/urban consumers stimulate production and services

LINK -> countryside revenue/food/raw materials sustain urban growth

BERNIER -> useful observation, but no-middle-strata claim is rejected

TRAP -> middle strata are not a modern political middle class.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Karkhana and craft production

GOODS -> cotton/silk + carpet + metal/arms + paper + sugar/indigo + ships

FORMS -> household + workshop + merchant advance + master labour + karkhana

KARKHANA -> imperial/noble organised workshop/store, not mechanised factory

TEXTILE ZONES -> Gujarat + Coromandel + Bengal specialisation

MERCHANT ADVANCE -> market coordination plus producer dependence

VERDICT -> high skill and commercial scale without modern industrialisation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Inland trade, hundi and banjara

MONEY -> rupee/dam/mohur + bullion; kind/barter and coin scarcity persist

HUNDI -> credit/remittance | SARRAF -> assay/change/banking

BANIAN/DALAL -> broker | AURANG -> warehouse/depot

BANJARA -> bulk grain/supply carrier; pack bullock and cart networks

ROUTES -> road/sarai/ferry + river + coastal craft + army markets

FRICTION -> monsoon + toll + insecurity + transport cost + local power.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Overseas trade, companies and bullion

EXPORT -> textiles + indigo + pepper + rice/sugar/raw silk by route

IMPORT -> bullion + horses + metals + luxuries; lists vary by decade

INDIAN NETWORKS -> Virji Vohra + Abdul Ghaffur + Bohras/Jains/Chettis

EUROPEANS -> Portuguese/Dutch/English/French enter existing Asian system

MUGHAL -> facilities/open ports; oppose fortification and seize agents on land

TRAP -> company growth is not immediate monopoly or territorial sovereignty.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Technology without stagnation or industrial teleology

CAPACITY -> irrigation + textiles + metallurgy/guns + ships + architecture

CONTACT -> clocks + pumps + telescope + mechanical devices adopted selectively

STRENGTH -> specialised artisanal skill and practical adaptation

LIMIT -> weak institutional bridge between learned theory and workshop experiment

OTHER LIMITS -> mechanisation + printing diffusion + energy organisation

VERDICT -> neither stagnant civilisation nor inevitable industrial takeoff.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Monetisation and long-distance trade coexisted with coercion, subsistence risk and marked regional variation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Culture as institutional and composite production

EDUCATION -> maktab/madrasa + pathshala/math + household + apprenticeship

LANGUAGE -> Persian/Arabic/Sanskrit + expanding regional literary publics

PAINT -> Akbar atelier -> Jahangir naturalism -> Shah Jahan formality -> dispersal

ARCH -> trabeate/arched craft -> marble/inlay/symmetry + regional labour

MUSIC -> court and regional/devotional patronage survive Aurangzeb

SYNTHESIS -> interaction without equal access, doctrinal erasure or romance.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Bernier, court chronicles and Mughal painting reveal positioned observations,
not a complete social census.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 24 final answer spine

DEFINE -> agrarian hierarchy + monetised commerce + institutional culture

SOCIETY -> noble/zamindar/cultivator/middle strata + caste/gender/slavery

ECONOMY -> crops/crafts + money/credit + transport + Indian/company trade

CULTURE -> education/languages + literature + painting/music/architecture

METHOD -> source estimate != census | jama != hasil | image != social total

PYQ -> direct 2018/19/20/22 Prelims + 2020 GS-I Persian-source demand

KEY -> 2018-23 objective key unavailable; inferred answer labelled

VERDICT -> dynamic and creative, but hierarchical, uneven and non-industrial.